

# STRAWBERRY DREAM SET

JUMPER AND SKIRT · SIZES 44 TO 92



A matching two-piece set: a top-down jumper with a round yoke and long sleeves, and a separate skirt with a soft elasticated waist. Both pieces share the same leaf and seed pattern. Graded in nine sizes, from small newborn to two years.

**44**

small newborn / preemie

**50**

newborn, 0-1 mo

**56**

1-2 mo

**62**

2-4 mo

**68**

4-6 mo

**74**

6-9 mo

**80**

9-12 mo

**86**

12-18 mo

**92**

18-24 mo, 2 years

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Little Montessori Explorers

[lmexplorers.com](http://lmexplorers.com)



Read the whole pattern before you start, and knit a gauge swatch. Mark your own size in the tables so you do not have to search as you go. **Test knit version 1.0**

## BEFORE YOU START

The jumper is knitted top-down with a round yoke and long sleeves, with no neck opening. The skirt is knitted separately, also from the top down, with a folded waistband that a soft elastic is threaded through at the end. The two pieces share the charts, the gauge and the colours, but are knitted entirely independently.

## WHAT YOU WILL LEARN

- knitting a jumper with a round yoke
- dividing for body and sleeves, and working sleeves in the round
- knitting a skirt with a folded, elasticated waistband
- adjusting the length and finishing with a scalloped edge

## DIFFICULTY

**Easy to slightly experienced. The sleeves are the only part with few stitches on the needle, and there Magic Loop or double-pointed needles help.**

## SIZES

The pattern is graded in nine sizes, from 44 to 92, that is from small newborn to two years. Choose by the child's chest measurement, not by age. The ages are only a guide, and a baby born early follows its own curve. Between two sizes, take the larger one, since a garment that is slightly big lasts longer.

### THE CHILD'S MEASUREMENTS

| Size | Suits                   | Child chest | Ease   |
|------|-------------------------|-------------|--------|
| 44   | small newborn / preemie | 32 cm       | 6,1 cm |
| 50   | newborn, 0-1 mo         | 35 cm       | 6,9 cm |
| 56   | 1-2 mo                  | 38 cm       | 5,8 cm |
| 62   | 2-4 mo                  | 41 cm       | 6,6 cm |
| 68   | 4-6 mo                  | 43 cm       | 6,5 cm |
| 74   | 6-9 mo                  | 45 cm       | 6,4 cm |
| 80   | 9-12 mo                 | 47 cm       | 6,3 cm |
| 86   | 12-18 mo                | 49 cm       | 6,2 cm |
| 92   | 18-24 mo, 2 years       | 51 cm       | 6,1 cm |

### HOW TO READ THE TABLES

Every number in the pattern is given in its own column per size. Find your column once, mark it with a pen, and read only that one from there on.

## FINISHED MEASUREMENTS

| Size | Jumper chest | Jumper length | Sleeve length | Skirt waist | Skirt length |
|------|--------------|---------------|---------------|-------------|--------------|
| 44   | 40,0 cm      | 23 cm         | 14 cm         | 34,3 cm     | 19 cm        |
| 50   | 43,8 cm      | 25 cm         | 16 cm         | 38,1 cm     | 21 cm        |
| 56   | 45,7 cm      | 27 cm         | 18 cm         | 41,9 cm     | 23 cm        |
| 62   | 49,5 cm      | 29 cm         | 20 cm         | 45,7 cm     | 25 cm        |
| 68   | 51,4 cm      | 31 cm         | 21 cm         | 49,5 cm     | 27 cm        |
| 74   | 53,3 cm      | 32 cm         | 22 cm         | 53,3 cm     | 29 cm        |
| 80   | 55,2 cm      | 34 cm         | 23 cm         | 57,1 cm     | 31 cm        |
| 86   | 57,1 cm      | 35 cm         | 24 cm         | 61,0 cm     | 33 cm        |
| 92   | 59,0 cm      | 36 cm         | 25 cm         | 64,8 cm     | 35 cm        |

The measurements below are the garment as it should be after washing and drying flat. If you get different measurements, it is usually the gauge and not the pattern.

## YARN, TOOLS AND GAUGE

### YARN AND NEEDLES

DROPS Merino Extra Fine, 50 g = approx. 105 m, in strawberry pink, leaf green and a small amount of cream white. The amounts below include a good margin, and are given per size.

| Tools          | For what                                                     |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4 mm needles   | double-pointed or Magic Loop for neck, sleeves and waistband |
| Soft elastic   | approx. 1 cm wide, for the skirt waistband                   |
| Darning needle | for weaving in ends and sewing down the waistband            |
| Stitch marker  | to mark the beginning of the round and each sleeve side      |

### YARN AMOUNT

| Size | Pink   | Green | Cream |
|------|--------|-------|-------|
| 44   | 710 g  | 65 g  | 5 g   |
| 50   | 870 g  | 70 g  | 5 g   |
| 56   | 1020 g | 75 g  | 5 g   |
| 62   | 1215 g | 85 g  | 5 g   |
| 68   | 1430 g | 90 g  | 5 g   |
| 74   | 1610 g | 95 g  | 5 g   |
| 80   | 1800 g | 95 g  | 5 g   |
| 86   | 2005 g | 100 g | 5 g   |
| 92   | 2220 g | 105 g | 5 g   |

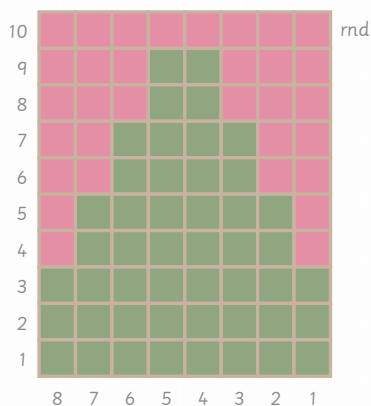
### GAUGE

21 stitches and 28 rounds in stocking stitch = 10 x 10 cm on 4 mm needles. Knit your swatch in the round, not flat, and measure it after washing and drying flat. More than 21 stitches means one needle size up, fewer means one down. The gauge decides every measurement here.

## LEAF AND SEED CHARTS

Both charts are read from the bottom up, and each round from right to left, the same way you knit. The leaf repeat is 8 stitches and is repeated all the way round the yoke. The number of repeats for your size is given further on.

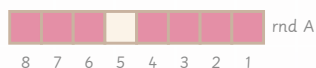
### LEAF, 8 STITCHES x 10 ROUNDS



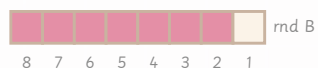
● leaf green ● strawberry pink ● cream white, one seed

### SEED, 8 STITCHES

A



B



The seeds are single cream white stitches scattered over the pink. Work round A, then 2-3 rounds in pink, then round B. Repeat as densely or as sparsely as you like.

**The float behind the work is never longer than 3 stitches in either chart. That is deliberate: long loose strands on the inside are both uncomfortable against the skin and something small fingers can catch in. Keep the carried yarn loose enough that the work does not pucker.**

## JUMPER · 1 · NECK AND YOKE

Cast on in green on 4 mm needles with a stretchy cast-on, join in the round and work 5 rounds of twisted rib. The jumper has no neck opening, so the neck has to pass over the head, and there the cast-on edge decides. Cast on loosely, for instance over two needles held together. Then divide the stitches into 8 equal sections, place a marker between each, and increase 1 stitch in each section every other round, that is 8 stitches per increase round, until you have the stitch count in your column. Work the even rounds in the last column, then the leaf repeat from page 5 over 8 stitches. Finish with 1 round in pink.

| Size | Cast on | Per section | Inc. rnds | Even rnds | Yoke    | Leaf rep. |
|------|---------|-------------|-----------|-----------|---------|-----------|
| 44   | 56 sts  | 7           | 7         | 3         | 112 sts | 14 x      |
| 50   | 64 sts  | 8           | 8         | 5         | 128 sts | 16 x      |
| 56   | 64 sts  | 8           | 9         | 5         | 136 sts | 17 x      |
| 62   | 72 sts  | 9           | 10        | 5         | 152 sts | 19 x      |
| 68   | 72 sts  | 9           | 11        | 5         | 160 sts | 20 x      |
| 74   | 80 sts  | 10          | 11        | 6         | 168 sts | 21 x      |
| 80   | 80 sts  | 10          | 12        | 6         | 176 sts | 22 x      |
| 86   | 80 sts  | 10          | 13        | 5         | 184 sts | 23 x      |
| 92   | 88 sts  | 11          | 13        | 6         | 192 sts | 24 x      |

The neck is calculated from the head, not guessed: it sits at 80 to 87 % of the head circumference in every size. The rib stretches the rest as the jumper goes on, and draws back in afterwards. If it still feels tight, it is almost always the cast-on edge that is too firm, not the stitch count.

## JUMPER · 2 · DIVIDE FOR BODY AND SLEEVES

Read the row for your size from left to right, in the order you knit: the front, the stitches you place on hold for the first sleeve, the stitches you cast on under the arm, the back, then the same sleeve on the other side. The jumper casts on 4 stitches under each arm, two more than the dress and the romper, because a sleeve needs a little extra width at the underarm.

| Size | Front | Hold for sleeve | Cast on | Back | Body    |
|------|-------|-----------------|---------|------|---------|
| 44   | 38    | 18              | 4       | 38   | 84 sts  |
| 50   | 42    | 22              | 4       | 42   | 92 sts  |
| 56   | 44    | 24              | 4       | 44   | 96 sts  |
| 62   | 48    | 28              | 4       | 48   | 104 sts |
| 68   | 50    | 30              | 4       | 50   | 108 sts |
| 74   | 52    | 32              | 4       | 52   | 112 sts |
| 80   | 54    | 34              | 4       | 54   | 116 sts |
| 86   | 56    | 36              | 4       | 56   | 120 sts |
| 92   | 58    | 38              | 4       | 58   | 124 sts |



## JUMPER • 3 • THE BODY

Work in pink stocking stitch in the round with seeds: seed round A, 2-3 rounds in pink, then seed round B. Repeat as densely or sparsely as you like. Work until the body measures the length in your column, measured straight down from the underarm. Change to green, work 6 rounds of twisted rib and cast off with stretch.

| Size | Body stitches | Chest   | Length from underarm | Rounds of rib |
|------|---------------|---------|----------------------|---------------|
| 44   | 84 sts        | 40,0 cm | 11 cm                | 6             |
| 50   | 92 sts        | 43,8 cm | 12 cm                | 6             |
| 56   | 96 sts        | 45,7 cm | 13 cm                | 6             |
| 62   | 104 sts       | 49,5 cm | 14 cm                | 6             |
| 68   | 108 sts       | 51,4 cm | 15 cm                | 6             |
| 74   | 112 sts       | 53,3 cm | 16 cm                | 6             |
| 80   | 116 sts       | 55,2 cm | 17 cm                | 6             |
| 86   | 120 sts       | 57,1 cm | 18 cm                | 6             |
| 92   | 124 sts       | 59,0 cm | 19 cm                | 6             |

**Always cast off loosely in rib. A tight cast-off stops the jumper from pulling down over the chest, and that shows most in the smallest sizes.**

## JUMPER · 4 · THE SLEEVES

Place the held sleeve stitches on the needle and pick up the stitches under the arm. Place a marker at the centre of the underarm. Work in pink stocking stitch in the round, with a few seeds spaced well apart. Decrease 1 stitch at each side of the marker, that is 2 stitches per decrease round, spread evenly over the length of the sleeve. The number of decrease rounds is given in your column.

| Size | Held stitches | Pick up | Upper arm | Decrease rounds | Cuff   | Sleeve length |
|------|---------------|---------|-----------|-----------------|--------|---------------|
| 44   | 18            | 4       | 22 sts    | 3               | 16 sts | 14 cm         |
| 50   | 22            | 4       | 26 sts    | 4               | 18 sts | 16 cm         |
| 56   | 24            | 4       | 28 sts    | 4               | 20 sts | 18 cm         |
| 62   | 28            | 4       | 32 sts    | 5               | 22 sts | 20 cm         |
| 68   | 30            | 4       | 34 sts    | 5               | 24 sts | 21 cm         |
| 74   | 32            | 4       | 36 sts    | 5               | 26 sts | 22 cm         |
| 80   | 34            | 4       | 38 sts    | 5               | 28 sts | 23 cm         |
| 86   | 36            | 4       | 40 sts    | 5               | 30 sts | 24 cm         |
| 92   | 38            | 4       | 42 sts    | 5               | 32 sts | 25 cm         |

### THE CUFF

When the sleeve measures approx. 2 cm less than the sleeve length in the table, change to green and work 6 rounds of twisted rib. Cast off with stretch. Work the second sleeve exactly the same.

## SKIRT · 5 · THE WAISTBAND

Cast on loosely in green and join in the round. The stitch count already divides by 8, so the leaf repeat comes out even without adjustment. Work 2.5 cm in stocking stitch, 1 purl round for the fold line, then another 2.5 cm in stocking stitch. Place the cast-on edge on a spare needle and knit one stitch from each needle together all the way round, leaving an opening of approx. 2 cm for the elastic.

| Size | Cast on | Leaf repeats | Waist   | Waistband height |
|------|---------|--------------|---------|------------------|
| 44   | 72 sts  | 9 x          | 34,3 cm | 2 x 2,5 cm       |
| 50   | 80 sts  | 10 x         | 38,1 cm | 2 x 2,5 cm       |
| 56   | 88 sts  | 11 x         | 41,9 cm | 2 x 2,5 cm       |
| 62   | 96 sts  | 12 x         | 45,7 cm | 2 x 2,5 cm       |
| 68   | 104 sts | 13 x         | 49,5 cm | 2 x 2,5 cm       |
| 74   | 112 sts | 14 x         | 53,3 cm | 2 x 2,5 cm       |
| 80   | 120 sts | 15 x         | 57,1 cm | 2 x 2,5 cm       |
| 86   | 128 sts | 16 x         | 61,0 cm | 2 x 2,5 cm       |
| 92   | 136 sts | 17 x         | 64,8 cm | 2 x 2,5 cm       |

**Cast on loosely. The waistband must stretch over the hips, and a tight cast-on edge is the most common reason a baby skirt will not go on.**

## SKIRT · 6 · LEAVES, WIDTH AND LENGTH

Work the leaf repeat from page 5 over 8 stitches, repeated as many times as your column says. Then change to pink and work \*k2, M1\*, repeat round. The skirt is now at full width. Continue in pink stocking stitch with scattered seeds until the skirt measures the length in the last column, measured below the waistband.

| Size | Waistband stitches | Leaf repeats | *k2, M1* gives | Skirt width | Length from waistband |
|------|--------------------|--------------|----------------|-------------|-----------------------|
| 44   | 72 sts             | 9 x          | 110 sts        | 52,4 cm     | 16 cm                 |
| 50   | 80 sts             | 10 x         | 120 sts        | 57,1 cm     | 18 cm                 |
| 56   | 88 sts             | 11 x         | 130 sts        | 61,9 cm     | 20 cm                 |
| 62   | 96 sts             | 12 x         | 140 sts        | 66,7 cm     | 22 cm                 |
| 68   | 104 sts            | 13 x         | 160 sts        | 76,2 cm     | 24 cm                 |
| 74   | 112 sts            | 14 x         | 170 sts        | 81,0 cm     | 26 cm                 |
| 80   | 120 sts            | 15 x         | 180 sts        | 85,7 cm     | 28 cm                 |
| 86   | 128 sts            | 16 x         | 190 sts        | 90,5 cm     | 30 cm                 |
| 92   | 136 sts            | 17 x         | 200 sts        | 95,2 cm     | 32 cm                 |

The leaves on the skirt point downwards, just as on the jumper yoke, so the two pieces match when worn together.

## SKIRT · 7 · SCALLOPED EDGE AND ELASTIC

### THE SCALLOPED HEM

Divide the edge into scallops with a marker between each. Every scallop is 10 stitches. Then work the scallop round: \*ssk, k2, M1R, k2, M1L, k2, k2tog\*, repeat round. The stitch count stays the same, but the edge begins to wave. Repeat the scallop round 5 times in all, then cast off loosely.

| Size | Stitches at hem | Scallops | Sts per scallop | Scallop rounds |
|------|-----------------|----------|-----------------|----------------|
| 44   | 110 sts         | 11       | 10              | 5              |
| 50   | 120 sts         | 12       | 10              | 5              |
| 56   | 130 sts         | 13       | 10              | 5              |
| 62   | 140 sts         | 14       | 10              | 5              |
| 68   | 160 sts         | 16       | 10              | 5              |
| 74   | 170 sts         | 17       | 10              | 5              |
| 80   | 180 sts         | 18       | 10              | 5              |
| 86   | 190 sts         | 19       | 10              | 5              |
| 92   | 200 sts         | 20       | 10              | 5              |

### THE ELASTIC

Measure the baby's waist and cut a soft elastic 1 cm shorter than the measurement. Thread it through the waistband with a safety pin, sew the ends firmly together with several rows of stitches, then close the opening in the waistband. The elastic should hold the skirt up without marking the skin. Check with a finger: you should slip easily under the waistband.

**On the smallest children the skin is especially delicate. If in doubt, choose the looser elastic and tighten it later if needed.**

## FOR YOU, THE TEST KNITTER

This edition of the set is a test knit version. Every stitch count has been calculated from the babies' measurements and the gauge, and checked against the others, but nobody has knitted from the pattern yet. You are the first. That means you may run into things I have not seen, and that is exactly why I need you.

### WHAT I NEED FROM YOU

- Which size you knitted, and which yarn and needles you used.
- Your own gauge, measured on a washed swatch dried flat.
- The finished measurements of the garment after washing, in the form below.
- Anything unclear: a sentence you had to read three times, a stitch count that did not add up, a place where you had to guess.
- A photo of the finished garment, on the baby if you like.
- Tell me if the pattern reminds you of one you have seen before. Strawberry Dream is drawn for LME, and I want to know straight away if something still sits too close to something else.

### MEASUREMENT FORM, FILL IN AFTER WASHING

Size knitted

-----

My gauge, rounds per 10 cm

-----

Chest after washing

-----

Time taken, roughly

-----

My gauge, stitches per 10 cm

-----

Yarn and needles

-----

Total length after washing

-----

Yarn used, grams

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### HOW TO SEND IT IN

Send the form, your comments and any photos to <https://lmexplorers.com/teststrikk>. The deadline is given in the email the pattern came in.

**Nothing is too small to mention. Whatever tripped you up will trip up the next knitter too, and it is far easier to fix now than later.**

## FINISHING AND AFTERCARE

### CHECKLIST

- Weave in all ends flat and firmly on the wrong side. Do not cut them flush.
- Soak the work in lukewarm water with wool detergent. Do not rub or wring.
- Press the water out in a towel and dry the garment flat to the given measurements.
- Check all buttons, ties, edges and loose ends before the garment is worn.
- Check that the elastic sits softly and leaves no marks after an hour of wear.
- Measure the garment after washing and write the numbers in the form on the previous page.

### SAFETY

Buttons and ties on children's garments must always be checked before use, and the garment worn only under supervision. Sew buttons on with strong thread and go over them again after every wash. In the smallest sizes the garment sits right against the skin, so feel that no seam or knot presses hard.

**Happy knitting!**

## STRAWBERRY DREAM

### THE WHOLE COLLECTION

- Strawberry Dream dress, sleeveless with a leaf yoke and a flared skirt.
- Strawberry Dream romper with skirt, with a nappy panel and buttons at the crotch.
- Strawberry Dream jumper and skirt, a two-piece set with an elasticated waist.
- Strawberry Dream mittens, thumbless, with a connecting cord, sizes 44 to 74.
- Strawberry Dream booties, with a folded rib cuff and ties at the ankle, sizes 44 to 92.

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